

BEE 4750 Homework 2: Systems Modeling and Simulation

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Due Date

Thursday, 09/25/25, 9:00pm

Overview

Instructions

- Problem 1 asks you to draw a systems diagram and identify the type of a feedback.
- Problem 2 asks you to model contaminant concentrations in a river and use simulation to compare the concentrations to a regulatory standard.
- Problem 3 asks you to explore the implications of an ice-albedo feedback in the Earth's climate system by understanding the equilibria of the modeled system and their stabilities.

Load Environment

The following code loads the environment and makes sure all needed packages are installed. This should be at the start of most Julia scripts.

```
import Pkg
Pkg.add("GraphRecipes")
Pkg.activate(@__DIR__)
Pkg.instantiate()
```

```

Resolving package versions...
Installed Adapt          v4.4.0
Installed GraphRecipes    v0.5.15
Installed ChainRulesCore  v1.26.0
Installed Interpolations  v0.16.2
Updating `C:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\hw2-sarah-nathan\Project.toml`
[bd48cda9] + GraphRecipes v0.5.15
Updating `C:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\hw2-sarah-nathan\Manifest.toml`
[1520ce14] + AbstractTrees v0.4.5
[79e6a3ab] + Adapt v4.4.0
[13072b0f] + AxisAlgorithms v1.1.0
[d360d2e6] + ChainRulesCore v1.26.0
[411431e0] + Extents v0.1.6
[5c1252a2] + GeometryBasics v0.5.10
[4d00f742] + GeometryTypes v0.8.5
[bd48cda9] + GraphRecipes v0.5.15
[a98d9a8b] + Interpolations v0.16.2
[46757867] + NetworkLayout v0.4.10
[6fe1bfb0] + OffsetArrays v1.17.0
[c84ed2f1] + Ratios v0.4.5
[efce3f68] + WoodburyMatrices v1.0.0
[5ae413db] + EarCut_jll v2.2.4+0
Precompiling project...
1584.2 ms    Adapt
1090.2 ms    EarCut_jll
2167.9 ms    ChainRulesCore
1138.6 ms    Adapt → AdaptSparseArraysExt
1420.2 ms    OffsetArrays → OffsetArraysAdaptExt
2002.5 ms    Adapt → AdaptStaticArraysExt
2794.9 ms    GeometryTypes
1478.1 ms    Roots → RootsChainRulesCoreExt
1537.4 ms    StaticArrays → StaticArraysChainRulesCoreExt
1818.3 ms    ChainRulesCore → ChainRulesCoreSparseArraysExt
2188.9 ms    LogExpFunctions → LogExpFunctionsChainRulesCoreExt
2739.4 ms    Interpolations
2001.6 ms    Interpolations → InterpolationsUnitfulExt
10519.0 ms   GeometryBasics
3897.2 ms    NetworkLayout
5325.8 ms    Plots → GeometryBasicsExt
2209.0 ms    NetworkLayout → NetworkLayoutGraphsExt
3736.6 ms    GraphRecipes
18 dependencies successfully precompiled in 27 seconds. 239 already precompiled.
Activating project at `c:\Users\sarah\OneDrive\Documents\GitHub\hw2-sarah-nathan`

```

```
using Plots
using LaTeXStrings
using CSV
using DataFrames
using Roots
using GraphRecipes
```

Problems (Total: 30 Points)

Problem 1 (5 points)

Draw a systems diagram for the relationship between global mean temperature, atmospheric CO₂ concentrations, and ocean CO₂ concentrations. What are the signs of the interactions between these components and why? What does this suggest about the overall feedback between temperature and the ocean carbon cycle?

Tip

Think about Henry's law for CO₂.

Problem 2 (15 points)

A river which flows at 10 km/d is receiving discharges of wastewater contaminated with CRUD from two sources which are 15 km apart, as shown in the Figure below. CRUD decays exponentially in the river at a rate of 0.36 d^{-1} and is deposited by the atmosphere along the river at a rate of 54 kg/km/d.

Schematic of the river system in Problem 2

Problem 2.1

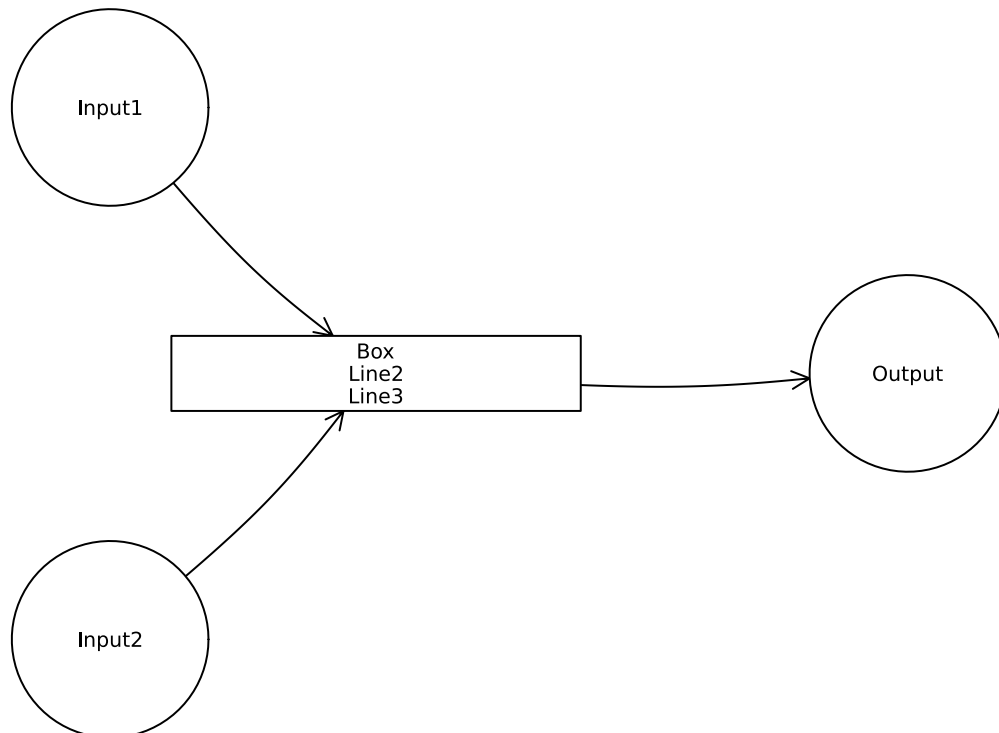
Draw a systems diagram with the relevant control volume(s) denoted and any relevant in/out-flows between these boxes. How did you decide how many boxes were needed?

```
A = [
    0 0 1 0;
    0 0 1 0;
    0 0 0 1;
    0 0 0 0
]
```

```

graphplot(
    A,
    names = ["Input1", "Input2", "Box\nLine2\nLine3", "Output"],
    nodeshape = [:circle, :circle, :rect, :circle],
    nodecolor = :white,
    markersize = 0.3,
    x = [-1.0, -1.0, 0.0, 2.0],
    y = [1.0, -1.0, 0.0, 0.0],
    arrow = true
)

```



Problem 2.2

Develop a model for the concentration of CRUD downriver by formulating and solving the appropriate differential equation(s) analytically.

Tip

Formulate your model in terms of distance downriver, rather than leaving it in terms of time from discharge.

Problem 2.3

Determine if the system is in compliance with a regulatory limit of 2.3 kg/(1000m³). You can do this analytically or computationally.

Problem 3 (10 points)

In class, we discussed the ice-albedo feedback and its possible influence on melting the hypothesized “Snowball Earth”. In this problem, we’ll introduce a simple model of the Earth’s energy balance which includes this feedback and examine the stability of the climate.

This simple model of the energy balance (averaged over the entire planet) is:

$$\underbrace{C \frac{dT}{dt}}_{\text{change in heat}} = \underbrace{\frac{(1-\alpha)S}{4}}_{\text{incoming radiation}} - \underbrace{(A - BT)}_{\text{outgoing radiation}} + \underbrace{a \ln \left(\frac{[CO_2]}{[CO_2]_{PI}} \right)}_{\text{greenhouse effect}}, \quad (1)$$

where:

- T is the Earth’s global mean temperature (in °C);
- C is the heat capacity of the atmosphere and shallow ocean, taken to be 51 J/m²/°C;
- α is the planetary albedo, or the fraction of incoming radiation reflected by the Earth, which has a present-day value of approximately 0.3;
- S is the solar constant, or the amount of solar radiation received by the Earth averaged over area, which has a present-day value of 1368 W/m² but during the Neoproterozoic Era had a value of 1272 W/m² (this is divided by four because the Earth is a sphere but S is the radiation captured by a disc with radius equal to that of the Earth);
- A and B are coefficients from the linearization of outgoing radiation physics, and have corresponding values $B = -1.3$ W/m²/°C (estimated from a number of lines of evidence about the sensitivity of outgoing radiation to temperature; this is negative due to a sign convention about the direction of incoming vs. outgoing radiation) and $A = 221.2$ W/m² (estimated by assuming the pre-industrial temperature of 14°C was stable without anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions).

We will ignore the greenhouse effect term as we are considering the Earth system well before humans were around.

Problem 3.1

Discretize the climate model (Equation 1) using forward Euler integration and a time step of $\Delta t = 1$ yr.

Problem 3.2

Rather than assuming a constant value for the albedo α , we will represent the ice-albedo feedback by letting α depend on T :

$$\alpha(T) = \begin{cases} \alpha_i & \text{if } T \leq -10^\circ\text{C} \\ \alpha_i + (\alpha_0 - \alpha_i)((T + 10)/20) & \text{if } -10^\circ\text{C} \leq T \leq 10^\circ\text{C} \\ \alpha_0 & \text{if } T \geq 10^\circ\text{C}. \end{cases}$$

Let $\alpha_i = 0.5$ and $\alpha_0 = 0.3$. Simulate the simple climate model using the Neoproterozoic value of S with temperature-varying albedo for initial values of T spanning $-60^\circ\text{C} \leq T_0 \leq 30^\circ\text{C}$ over a period of 200 years. Plot the temperature trajectories. How many equilibria are there and what are their stabilities?

Problem 3.3

One might hypothesize that one cause for the transition from Snowball Earth (the stable frozen equilibrium from Problem 3.2) was an increasing amount of incoming solar radiation (as expressed by an increase in S). Examine this hypothesis using our simple model. Is this factor enough to cause the planet to warm to the pre-industrial temperature of 14°C ?

References

List any external references consulted, including classmates.